

If the nearly 300,000 Malawians abroad (1966 Census) were all repatriated within a few months, the country's economy and political stability would be strained. The contributions from deferred pay, family remittances, and other migrant-connected expenditures to the economic health of Malawi have been significant. Tables 2 and 3 give figures for migrant remittances and net capital inflows by source country for the years 1959 to 1967. They illustrate the decreasing importance of Rhodesia as an emigrant destination and the corresponding growth of African mines as employers of Malawians. Zambian remittances doubled between 1966 and 1967 because many Malawian workers moved north after Rhodesia's unilateral declaration of independence in November 1965. (According to the Rhodesian Yearbook

These provisions were inadequate when compared with Wene's benefits under the 1949 agreement which came into effect on January 1, 1949. It included free round-trip transportation, compulsory repatriation of uncontracted workers after two years, and compulsory deferred pay and family remittances in the Workbook Scheme. Families were urged to emigrate, in which case repatriation and remittances were not mandatory (Nyasaaland 1950, Annual Report). This remained in effect until terminated by the Southern Rhodesian government on July 1960. Since 1963, as Table 1 shows, the historical tendency for most Malawians to head for Rhodesia has reversed itself due to localization of employment; the majority go to South Africa. However, the Rhodesian African Labour Supply Commission (Mtandizi) continues to recruit limited numbers in Malawi as it has since 1947.

In 1936 the Nyasaland government signed the initial Inter-territorial Labour Agreement (the Salisbury Agreement) with Northern and Southern Rhodesia. This compact provided that all workers going abroad be issued certificates which were necessary for admittance to any of the three territories involved. Before the papers were issued, District Commissioners were to satisfy themselves that families were provided for. With certain exceptions, workers to be repatriated after two years. Free transportation was available by bus or train to Southern Rhodesia; rest camps and food depots were established along migrant routes; voluntary family remittances were encouraged; and a labor representative was stationed at Salisbury (CO.O 525/161).

Before 1965 Malawians who entered South Africa illegally were allowed stay upon purchase of a five shilling temporary residence permit. In that Republic began to require that all aliens in the country possess international passports. In 1967, in order to protect its citizens, Malawi signed a labor agreement with South Africa. The agreement states that all free-flow immigration should cease, that all Malawi nationals in South Africa except Wena should obtain passports and employment record books, and that they should be on contract with present and future employers. It was recommended also that national employment opportunities in South Africa be made available for Malawians. Two-year contracts provided that no local labor was at hand (Malawi Ministry External Affairs 1967).

voluntary, and a Nyasaland labor office was opened in Johannesburg to look after the worker's interests and incidentally to collect home taxes (C.O.525/161). Basic provisions remain in effect today, augmented by improvements such as the round-trip transportation and compulsory deferred pay and family remittances. Tracts are for eighteen or twenty-four months. Under these provisions earnings has remained high; on November 30, 1970, there were 92,169 Malawians working Transvaal and Orange Free State mines (Interview 1972).